ROALLA



EXECUTIVE VOICE AND UNIFIED COMMUNICATIONS GUIDE

Voice and Unified Communications Modernization Guide 2026

A decision framework for reducing communications cost eliminating legacy complexity and enabling a modern connected workforce

Prepared for Canadian boards, chief executives, technology, finance, operations, facilities, security and customer experience leaders

Prepared by ROALLA Transformation and Technology Advisory

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Purpose

This guide helps management decide how to move from analog services, legacy telephone systems and fragmented VoIP environments to a secure, resilient and cost-effective unified communications model. It connects business outcomes, service inventory, licensing economics, network readiness, emergency calling, security, adoption and decommissioning into one evidence-based modernization decision.

EXECUTIVE DECISION DASHBOARD

Management View at a Glance

Management should authorize modernization only after the organization has established a complete service and dependency inventory, a credible current-cost baseline, a fit-for-purpose target architecture, verified network and emergency-calling readiness, an executable migration plan and accountable ownership for retiring legacy contracts and infrastructure.

Executive question	ROALLA view	Decision implication
Is modernization justified?	**CONDITIONAL**	Confirm avoidable run cost, service risk and measurable workforce or customer outcomes.
Is the current estate understood?	**PREPARE**	Inventory every number, circuit, contract, device, application and analog dependency.
Can cloud voice operate reliably?	**CONDITIONAL**	Validate network quality, identity, security, emergency calling and site survivability.
Can savings be captured?	**DECIDE**	Tie migrations to licence removal, carrier exits, hardware retirement and contract dates.
What should management authorize?	**PURSUE**	A 90-day estate diagnostic, target-state design and controlled pilot business case.

Recommended Management Posture

Proceed through a small number of explicit decision gates. Preserve evidence as work occurs, separate discovery from implementation, and require each investment to demonstrate value, feasibility, control effectiveness and accountable ownership before scale.

EXECUTIVE DECISION MODEL

The Eight Communications Modernization Gates

A voice modernization program is investment-ready only when cost reduction, service quality and workforce enablement are supported by a complete dependency view and a controlled transition plan. A failed hard gate moves the initiative from Pursue to Prepare regardless of an attractive platform price.

Stage	Gate	Required conclusion	Decision evidence
01	Outcomes	Business case and service outcomes	Approved objectives, baseline and executive sponsor
02	Estate	Complete services and dependency inventory	Numbers, circuits, systems, devices, contracts and owners
03	Economics	Defensible total cost and benefit model	Current run rate, transition cost and savings case
04	Target state	Fit-for-purpose service and architecture	User profiles, platform pattern, integrations and support model
05	Network	Voice quality and site resilience	Capacity, quality, power, carrier and failover evidence
06	Safety	Emergency calling and critical-service continuity	Location, routing, testing, outage and escalation controls
07	Migration	Number, user, site and dependency transition	Pilot, porting waves, rollback and adoption plan
08	Exit	Legacy retirement and benefit realization	Decommission evidence, contract exits and value tracking

Decision Rule

A failed hard gate moves the initiative to Prepare or Monitor. A strong narrative, senior sponsor or attractive market cannot replace missing authority, evidence, delivery capacity or operating control.

SECTION 01

Readiness Framework

Translate ambition into a shared executive view of value, evidence, capability and risk.



Readiness Dimensions

Dimension	Decision area	Management evidence	Status
01	Business value	Cost reduction, service outcomes, sponsor and measures	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
02	Estate	Numbers, lines, trunks, systems, devices and contracts	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
03	Technology	UCaaS, calling, network, identity and integrations	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
04	Risk	Emergency calling, security, privacy and continuity	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
05	People	User profiles, workflow, adoption and support	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
06	Economics	Run rate, transition cost, savings and benefit realization	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**

Evidence Standard

Assessments should distinguish verified evidence from management confidence. Where evidence is incomplete, record the gap, owner, completion date and decision that depends on it.

STRATEGIC READINESS DEPENDENCIES

What Readiness Depends On

Dependency	Why it matters	Evidence management should expect
Outcomes	Business case and service outcomes	Approved objectives, baseline and executive sponsor
Estate	Complete services and dependency inventory	Numbers, circuits, systems, devices, contracts and owners
Economics	Defensible total cost and benefit model	Current run rate, transition cost and savings case
Target state	Fit-for-purpose service and architecture	User profiles, platform pattern, integrations and support model
Network	Voice quality and site resilience	Capacity, quality, power, carrier and failover evidence
Safety	Emergency calling and critical-service continuity	Location, routing, testing, outage and escalation controls
Migration	Number, user, site and dependency transition	Pilot, porting waves, rollback and adoption plan
Exit	Legacy retirement and benefit realization	Decommission evidence, contract exits and value tracking

ROALLA Interpretation

Dependencies should be evaluated as a connected system. A weakness in ownership, data, architecture, delivery or governance can change the economics and risk of an otherwise attractive initiative.

SECTION 02

Detailed Readiness Assessment

Convert executive intent into verifiable requirements, accountable evidence and clear remediation actions.



READINESS CHECKLIST

Current Estate and Dependency Readiness

Completion standard Mark Ready only when the supporting evidence has been verified. Assign an evidence owner to every open item.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
A01	An executive sponsor owns the modernization outcomes, budget and cross-functional decisions.	☐	☐	_____
A02	The organization has inventoried telephone numbers, toll-free services, circuits, trunks and carriers.	☐	☐	_____
A03	PBX, key systems, gateways, session border controllers, handsets and support arrangements are documented.	☐	☐	_____
A04	Analog dependencies include elevators, alarms, fax, paging, door entry, intercom and specialized equipment.	☐	☐	_____
A05	User profiles distinguish knowledge workers, front-line staff, reception, executives, shared spaces and contact-centre users.	☐	☐	_____
A06	Current contracts, renewal dates, minimum commitments, termination rights and porting restrictions are known.	☐	☐	_____
A07	The baseline separates licences, carrier charges, maintenance, hardware, support, moves and internal labour.	☐	☐	_____
A08	Usage evidence identifies inactive users, duplicate services, underused features and avoidable long-distance cost.	☐	☐	_____
A09	Critical sites and calling workflows have documented availability, power and connectivity requirements.	☐	☐	_____
A10	Call recording, retention, privacy, accessibility and industry-specific obligations have accountable owners.	☐	☐	_____

READINESS CHECKLIST CONTINUED

Target Solution and Migration Readiness

Completion standard Use Gap to create a dated remediation action and identify the management decision that cannot proceed.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
B01	The target architecture defines UCaaS, PSTN connectivity, identity, devices, administration and service ownership.	☐	☐	_____
B02	Network assessments validate bandwidth, latency, jitter, packet loss, Wi-Fi, segmentation and monitoring.	☐	☐	_____
B03	Emergency-calling design covers user location, dispatch information, testing, remote work and change control.	☐	☐	_____
B04	Resilience design covers internet, carrier and power outages, critical sites, failover and alternate communications.	☐	☐	_____
B05	Administrative access uses strong authentication, least privilege, logging and controlled provisioning.	☐	☐	_____
B06	Integration requirements cover contact centre, CRM, collaboration, directories, workflows and compliance tools.	☐	☐	_____
B07	The number-porting plan validates ownership, records, sequencing, lead times, freezes and rollback conditions.	☐	☐	_____
B08	A representative pilot tests call quality, emergency calling, workflows, integrations, devices and support readiness.	☐	☐	_____
B09	Change plans include communications, role-based training, floor support, accessibility and adoption measures.	☐	☐	_____
B10	Each migration wave has legacy shutdown, licence removal, contract exit and benefits-verification criteria.	☐	☐	_____

WEIGHTED EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Readiness Scorecard

Dimension	Weight	Evidence standard	Score	Status
Business value	20%	Cost reduction, service outcomes, sponsor and measures	__/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Estate	20%	Numbers, lines, trunks, systems, devices and contracts	__/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Technology	15%	UCaaS, calling, network, identity and integrations	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Risk	15%	Emergency calling, security, privacy and continuity	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
People	15%	User profiles, workflow, adoption and support	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Economics	15%	Run rate, transition cost, savings and benefit realization	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
TOTAL	100%	Weighted executive assessment	__/100	Pursue / Prepare / Monitor

Decision Thresholds

Score	Posture	Management decision
75 to 100	**PURSUE**	Proceed to bounded execution subject to no hard-gate failure.
50 to 74	**PREPARE**	Complete a focused readiness plan before major commitment.
0 to 49	**MONITOR**	Resolve foundational gaps before investing further.

A single material hard-gate failure overrides the weighted score. ROALLA also applies judgment where administrative readiness is high but strategic value, adoption or commercial viability is weak.

SECTION 03

Execution and Advisory Roadmap

Sequence decisions, evidence and delivery so management can invest with confidence and stop weak initiatives early.



Recommended 90 Day Mobilization

Timing	Focus	Key activities	Management output
Days 1 to 15	Mobilize	Confirm sponsor, scope, decision rights, evidence request and priority outcomes.	Approved mandate and fact base
Days 16 to 35	Assess	Review current evidence, interview owners, score readiness and identify hard gates.	Verified gaps and risk view
Days 36 to 55	Design	Define target operating, architecture, control and delivery options with economics.	Decision-ready options
Days 56 to 75	Validate	Test assumptions with users, data, technology, vendors and accountable control owners.	Evidence-backed recommendation
Days 76 to 90	Authorize	Approve the roadmap, owners, funding, measures, next gate and stop conditions.	Executive investment decision

Twelve to Twenty Four Month Path

- Quarter 1: establish the fact base, governance and one bounded priority initiative.
- Quarter 2: prove value and control effectiveness in a production-relevant pilot.
- Quarters 3 and 4: scale reusable capabilities, operating ownership and benefits realization.
- Year 2: optimize economics, institutionalize governance and refresh the portfolio using measured results.

ROALLA ADVISORY MODEL

How ROALLA Can Help

ROALLA acts as the technology and commercialization advisor coordinating strategy, evidence, architecture, governance, partners and executive decisions. The objective is not to maximize activity. It is to direct management effort toward investments that are valuable, controllable and executable.

ROALLA workstream	Executive value
Executive diagnostic	Establish the current fact base, hard gates, readiness score and management decisions.
Strategy and portfolio	Translate corporate priorities into a bounded, sequenced investment portfolio.
Architecture and data	Define target capabilities, integration, data, model, cloud and operating patterns.
Governance and risk	Design decision rights, policies, evidence, controls, monitoring and escalation.
Commercial and financial case	Model customer value, productivity, cost, funding, timing and benefits realization.
Vendor and partner ecosystem	Structure evaluation, sourcing, research, delivery and commercial relationships.
Execution readiness	Build roadmaps, work plans, budgets, measures, owners and decision gates.
Ongoing assurance	Monitor the portfolio, challenge evidence and bring decision-ready options to leadership.

Recommended Initial Mandate

- Four-week executive readiness diagnostic using this guide.
- Prioritized decision and evidence map with Pursue, Prepare and Monitor recommendations.
- One flagship initiative dossier with roadmap, economics, architecture and control plan.
- Executive readout and 90-day mobilization plan with accountable owners.

CONTROL FRAMEWORK

Key Risks and Controls

Risk	Exposure	ROALLA control
Incomplete inventory	Unknown lines or devices fail after cutover.	Reconcile invoices, carrier records, dial plans, site walks and owner attestations.
Analog dependency	Life-safety or operational devices cannot use the target service.	Test each dependency and choose replace, adapt, retain or retire with an accountable owner.
Emergency calling	Location or routing data is inaccurate during an emergency.	Design, validate and periodically test location, notification and escalation controls.
Voice quality	Poor network conditions undermine calls and adoption.	Measure sites and paths, remediate capacity and Wi-Fi, and monitor quality continuously.
Resilience	Cloud voice fails during power, carrier or internet disruption.	Define critical users and sites, alternate paths, power continuity and operating procedures.
Cost leakage	Legacy charges and duplicate licences continue after migration.	Make decommissioning and invoice validation mandatory completion gates.
Contract timing	Renewals or porting constraints delay savings and increase transition cost.	Sequence decisions against notice periods, commitments, lead times and commercial leverage.
Adoption	Users bypass the platform or recreate fragmented workflows.	Design by persona, pilot real workflows, train by role and measure usage and service outcomes.

Professional Advice

Qualified legal, privacy, security, tax, accounting, employment and regulatory advisors should validate matters within their professional scope. ROALLA coordinates those inputs with technology strategy, architecture, commercialization, governance and transformation decisions.

OFFICIAL EVIDENCE BASE

Selected Official Sources

These sources support the management principles summarized in this guide. Standards, laws, guidance and organizational obligations continue to evolve and must be confirmed for the specific context before acting.

CRTC Next generation 9 1 1. Official source — Current Canadian transition information and telecommunications provider readiness expectations for next generation emergency calling.

CRTC 9 1 1 services for traditional wireline VoIP and wireless services. Official source — Canadian guidance on emergency calling for fixed and nomadic VoIP services, including location and outage considerations.

CRTC 9 1 1 obligations for local VoIP service providers. Official source — Official overview of Canadian 9 1 1 obligations that apply to local VoIP service providers.

Canadian Centre for Cyber Security baseline controls. Official source — Canadian baseline cyber controls for small and medium organizations.

NIST Cybersecurity Framework 2.0. Official source — Outcome-based framework for governing and managing cybersecurity risk.

Advisory Disclaimer

This ROALLA guide is a strategic readiness and marketing document. It is not a certification, audit opinion, legal opinion, privacy opinion, security assurance, investment recommendation or guarantee of results. Management must validate current obligations, company facts and professional advice before making material decisions.